

XIX. Ego Plancium, Laterensis, et ipsum gratiosum esse dico et habuisse in petitione multos cupidos sui gratiosos, quos tu si sodales vocas, officiosam amicitiam nomine inquinans criminoso. Sin, quia gratiosi sint, accusandos putas, noli mirari te id, quod tua dignitas postularit, repudiandis
 47 gratiosorum amicitias non esse assecutum. Nam, ut ego doceo, gratiosum esse in sua tribu Plancium, quod multis benigne fecerit, pro multis spoponderit, in operas plurimos patris auctoritate et gratia miserit, quod denique omnibus officiis per se, per patrem, per maiores suos totam Atinatem praefecturam comprehenderit, sic tu doce sequestrem fuisse, largitum esse, conscripsisse, tribules decurivisse. Quid si non potes, noli tollere ex ordine nostro liberalitatem, noli maleficio putare esse gratiam, noli observantiam sancire poena.

Itaque haesitantem te in hoc sodalitiis tribu crimine ad communem ambitus causam contulisti, in qua desinamus aliquando, si videtur,
 48 vulgari et pervagata declamatione contendere. Sic enim tecum ago. Quam tibi commodum est, unam tribum delige tu : doce id, quod debes, per quem

XIX. I tell you, Laterensis, that not only is Plancius himself popular, but that the host of ardent supporters who backed his candidature were also popular. If you apply to these the name of "associates," you are sully disinterested friendship with a name which is a stain ; but if you think that their popularity renders them amenable to prosecution, cease to wonder that by your refusal to cultivate the friendship of popular persons you should have failed to win that distinction which your merits demanded
 47 as their due. For as I, on my side, prove that Plancius is a popular man in his tribe, and that he has become so by showing kindnesses to many, acting as security for many, and procuring official posts for several through his father's interest and popularity, and finally that by his own merits, his father's, and those of his ancestors, he has included the whole prefecture of Atina in the circle of his universal beneficence, so it lies with you to prove that he was a depositary and a bestower of bribes, and that he worked by registers and tribal allotments. If you cannot do this, do not rob our order of its free and open spirit, do not consider popularity to be a misdemeanour, or attach a penalty to the amenities of life.

Floundering, therefore, in this charge of corrupting the tribes by association, you have clutched at the general charge of bribery ; and, in discussing this, let us once and for all, if you please, have done with the stale and vapid commonplaces of rhetoric.
 48 I will deal with the matter in this way. Choose any one tribe which it suits your book to choose ; prove (for the burden of proof lies with you) who were